

would consider opting instead for a yearly gym subscription, which costs just as much.

On the other hand, wearables seem to have much greater short-term value for corporates and startups. In the case of service industries, wearables can boost employee efficiency by providing them with convenient access to process data and instructions, while their hands are left free to handle machinery and equipment. Wearables can also lead to extensive cost savings in complicated and expensive enterprise processes. For example, oil-drilling companies spend up to hundreds of millions in identifying and exploring drilling sites. They could equip on-site workers with customized wearable devices to stream real-time data and information from a control room. These can also monitor and control staff communication changes, and potentially highlight any gaps in communication, which is often a common factor in process errors.

APX Labs, the creators of the Smartglass software for the Xbox One, estimate the number of desk-less workers in the United States who could benefit from implementing wearables is about 40 million. This is across a number of sectors including healthcare, retail or wholesale, manufacturing, government, transportation, construction, as well as resources and utilities. After its initial demonstrations at the recent Windows 10 conference, Microsoft's HoloLens was hailed as being the next big thing in the field of augmented reality, and for good reason.

The HoloLens features a transparent “holographic” display on which the headset can project overlays of virtual images. These images can then be manipulated by motion and gestures. This sort of technology is a God-send in jobs and services that require complex spatial conceptualizations such as architecture and city planning to name a few. Offsite trainers can demonstrate complex tasks to employees by projecting instructions over existing real-life projects. Collaboration can also be made easier; imagine teams sharing design ideas in a three-dimensional space. If properly executed, HoloLens has the potential for wide commercial adoption in the enterprise space.

The Future of Marketing

At present, the best means of gaining marketing data is through online interactions. The information that you share on social media, the posts you like, the links you share, the websites that you visit, even the email you read, are all valuable data that marketers thrive for. While the accuracy